

specialization that developed during the boom years turns out to be uneconomic, unaffordable, or unwanted. People may be willing to pay someone to park their car when they are flush. But when they are broke, they will park their own cars.

As the division of labor goes backward, people also find they must tend to their own food and energy needs. Here is where it gets very tough for people who live in cities. They have no stores of Mason jars with food from their own gardens that they have canned themselves. They have no hams hanging in the barn or stocked away in the larder. They have no animals on the hoof that they can slaughter. They get no eggs from the chickens they don't have, and they can hardly go into the local park and shoot squirrels to make a pie.

Instead, they are out of luck.

Generally, when the black swans come out, you are better off in the country—with country-boy skills, real friends and family close at hand, and old-time farm supplies.

We once met a fellow who had a keen appreciation for apocalypse. He was sure it was coming. So he moved to Arkansas where, he said, "I'm protected by 300 miles of armed hillbillies."

That's something else to think about. Not only do you have to worry about food and energy, you also have to worry about your neighbors. If you have a nice little vegetable garden next to a large apartment complex, for example, you might have a hard time protecting your crops. And don't count on fattening a calf in Central Park during a famine.

You need to be somewhere else. Where?

"Little electricity or gasoline," reports an eyewitness from the *Washington Post*, visiting Sendai, Japan, in March 2011. "Nearly all restaurants and shops are closed . . . roads blocked, supplies depleted . . . the devastation . . . is catastrophic."⁴

We are elaborating on the benefits of having a family stronghold . . . a retreat . . . a bolt-hole somewhere. When the going gets tough, you need a tough place to go to.

In 2011, we saw two big blow-ups: one in the Arab countries, the other in Japan.